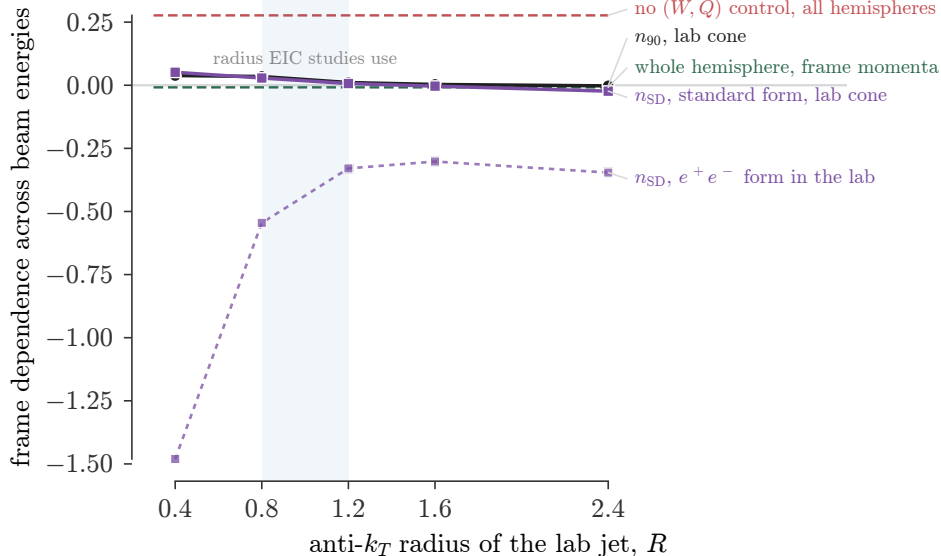




Exponent $d \ln \langle \cdot \rangle / d \ln |\vec{p}|_{\text{lab}}$ in fixed (W, Q) cells across the three beam configurations, against the radius of the laboratory cone. At the radius the EIC community actually uses, a plain lab cone is already frame independent for n_{90} ; the $R = 0.4$ inherited from the reference paper is the worst case, for n_{90} and for soft-drop multiplicity in its standard form alike. The dotted curve is the e^+e^- form of soft drop, with an absolute opening-angle cut applied in the laboratory: no radius rescues it, because the problem is the variables, not the cone.